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# The New York Times



Damage this week in Lebanon, where Israel and the Tehran-backed Hezbollah are at war. Neither has signed on to the Iran deal.

## TRUMP ESCALATES PUSH ON VOTER ID

Retracts Spy Chief Pick  
to Pressure Congress

By **MICHAEL GOLD**  
and **DUSTIN VOLZ**

WASHINGTON — President Trump said on Wednesday that he was pulling back his own nominee to be the nation’s top intelligence official as he again tried to pressure Congress to pass a strict voter identification law that does not have enough support among Republicans to advance.

Mr. Trump announced last week that he would nominate Jay Clayton, the U.S. attorney in Manhattan, to be the director of national intelligence, after senators in both parties condemned his earlier decision to install Bill Pulte, a loyalist and his top housing official, to the post.

Senate leaders had sought to quickly confirm Mr. Clayton, hoping to clear the way for a bipartisan agreement to renew a surveillance law that expired last week. The bill to extend it collapsed amid the furor over Mr. Pulte, who has no national security experience and drew withering bipartisan criticism. And some Democrats had indicated they might be willing to fast-track Mr. Clayton’s confirmation, eager to block Mr. Pulte from the post.

But Mr. Trump scuttled that plan in his social media post early Wednesday morning, just hours before Mr. Clayton was scheduled to have a confirmation hearing before the Senate Intelligence Committee. He said he would delay the proceedings, all but guaranteeing Mr. Pulte would take the job at the end of this week as the acting director of national intelligence.

And Mr. Trump threatened to block the extension of the powerful spying statute, Section 702 of the Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act or FISA, which expired on Saturday, unless a measure to reauthorize it was attached to elections legislation that would impose national requirements on voter identification and registration.

The Senate majority leader, John Thune, a South Dakota Republican, has said repeatedly that the elections measure does not have enough votes to advance and warned this week that appending it to the surveillance legislation would “tank” the FISA bill.

The president cannot cancel a Senate hearing, which is set by

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## How Trump Weighed Suspending a Legal Right

By **MAGGIE HABERMAN**  
and **JONATHAN SWAN**

Last spring, Will Scharf, an archconservative lawyer serving as the White House staff secretary, wrote a secret memo to the chief of staff that reflected growing unease in the West Wing about one of the extreme measures being weighed by Stephen Miller, the powerful adviser driving President Trump’s deportation campaign.

Dated April 29, 2025, and stamped “confidential,” the memo was careful and lawyerly but amounted to a warning against end-running the rule of law. The subject line read: “THE WRIT OF HABEAS CORPUS.”

Habeas corpus — the centuries-old right to force the government to justify, before a judge, why it

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## A Memo Details a Push to Bypass Judges in Deportations

has locked a person up — is enshrined in Article I of the Constitution. Mr. Scharf’s memo, in its unassuming way, was a blinking red warning light. The second Trump White House was deliberating an explosive new claim of presidential power: the suspension of habeas rights for unauthorized immigrants.

The suspension of habeas corpus has occurred just a handful of times in U.S. history, and always under the most dire circumstances of war or invasion. Yet to a greater degree than previously

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known, administration officials, encouraged by Mr. Trump, actively weighed taking that step in the early months of his second term — this time to accelerate the mass deportation of immigrants in the country illegally.

Flush with a decisive 2024 election victory, Mr. Trump and some members of his team wanted to test how far the emboldened president’s authority could be pushed, setting off previously unreported internal struggles over where the limits should be.

The man who outlined his concerns in the memo, Mr. Scharf, was no resistance figure. A Harvard-trained lawyer who had run for office in Missouri, he had bemoaned John McCain as too moderate for the 2008 Republican nomination, and believed Mr.

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## NYNJ Stadium? A Cross-State Kick in the Teeth.

By **MATTHEW PURDY**

EAST RUTHERFORD, N.J. — The waters between New Jersey and New York have been choppy at least since the Statue of Liberty arrived from France in the late 19th century and, confusingly, took up residence in New Jersey’s half of the Hudson River, but on an island owned by New York.

Anthony Lynn, a retired Verizon technician and son of Jersey City, is reminded of this historic dis whenever he gets a glimpse of Lady Liberty from the Jersey side. “All I know is,” he said, “its back is to us.”

That about sums up how New Jersey sees its treatment by New York. Forever getting the backside view.

Now comes the World Cup, a glorious global event that will reach its peak on July 19 with the final match being played at a stadium that sits squarely and indisputably in New Jersey.

A nice moment for New Jersey. And a ripe opportunity for a fresh dis from New York.

New Jersey and New York City won a bid to host a total of eight matches, all to be played at MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford. But the international soccer federation, FIFA, decreed that stadiums hosting World Cup matches had to temporarily shed their corporate names. The New Jersey stadium was renamed NYNJ Stadium. NYNJ? The unkindest abbreviation of all!

It appears to be a bit of an own

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MetLife Stadium in East Rutherford, N.J., has been temporarily renamed for the World Cup, raising hackles in the Garden State.

NATIONAL A10-17, 20

### Divisive Redistricting Halted

Georgia Republicans pulled the plug on gerrymandering away U.S. House seats held by Black Democrats. PAGE A11

### Mental Health Defense in Trial

Luigi Mangione’s lawyers plan to use emotional disturbance as his defense in a health executive’s killing. PAGE A20



INTERNATIONAL A4-9

### Nationality Revoked Amid War

Bahrain has stripped 69 people of their citizenship, including children, accusing them of disloyalty, and tried to expel them to Iran. PAGE A4

### Japan Questions Frozen Assets

The Fair Trade Commission said that it suspected six leading ice cream manufacturers fixed the prices of popular frozen treats. PAGE A9

### A Language All Its Own

A hybrid dialect unique to Ecuador’s Andes region is a seamless mix of Kichwa and Spanish that bends grammar and adds melody. PAGE A8

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### Trump’s New Head at the Fed

America’s central bank held interest rates steady as inflation fears dominated Kevin M. Warsh’s first meeting as chairman. PAGE B1

### Anthropic Puzzled by Trump

Employees at the company are questioning the administration’s decision to limit their latest A.I. models. PAGE B1

THURSDAY STYLES D1-6

### An Artist’s Sartorial Vision

As with his paintings, David Hockney favored bold colors and a whimsical approach for his wardrobe. PAGE D1

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### Facing a Language Barrier

Pommellen Thijs is a big pop star in Belgium, though not in the French-speaking portion of the nation. PAGE C1

### Respite From ‘Widow’s Bay’

Matthew Rhys, the star of the seafaring horror-comedy on Apple TV, spends his off time on the water, too. PAGE C1



THE WEATHER

Today, warm, humid, a morning shower, afternoon thunderstorm, high 86. Tonight, cloudy, low 69. Tomorrow, less humid, partly sunny, high 82. Weather map, Page B12.

# TRUMP LASHES OUT AT CRITICS OF DEAL AS DETAILS EMERGE

WHITE HOUSE MEMO  
A Struggle to Outdo  
the Obama Pact

By **DAVID E. SANGER**

WASHINGTON — Only minutes into a phone call to a New York Times reporter to explain the deal he had just agreed to with Iran, President Trump turned to an issue that clearly grates on him: the comparisons to the deal that President Barack Obama struck with Tehran in 2015.

The Obama deal, he said on Sunday evening, repeating a well-worn line, was “a disaster.”

“It was a road to a nuclear weapon and ours is a wall against a nuclear weapon in the truest sense of the word,” Mr. Trump said. “So let’s start there.”

Mr. Trump’s sensitivity is easy to understand. He campaigned against the Obama-era deal as far back as 2015, and ultimately killed it during his first term over the objections of many of his top national security aides. At the time, he had a long list of complaints about its failings. The 2015 accord “lifted crippling economic sanctions on Iran in exchange for very weak limits on the regime’s nuclear activity,” Mr. Trump said in a 2018 speech, and “no limits at all on its other malign behavior,” especially its support of terror activities around the Middle East.

On Wednesday, as the Group of 7 summit in France wrapped up, Mr. Trump heaped more scorn on the 2015 deal and his predecessor, including for unfreezing \$1.7 billion in Iranian funds held in foreign banks, something his own pending accord envisions on a larger scale. “And you know what the Iranians did?” he asked reporters. “They laughed at Obama, and they said he’s a stupid son of a bitch.”

Now the moment of reckoning has come for Mr. Trump. He is caught in what could best be described as the Obama-deal bind.

The accord he described on Sunday, and celebrated on Wednesday in France, is chiefly a cease-fire and an agreement to fully open the Strait of Hormuz for 60 days. It commits both sides to begin negotiating on the

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Denies U.S. to Fund  
\$300 Billion Plan  
to Rebuild Iran

This article is by **Erica L. Green, Zolan Kanno-Youngs, Farnaz Fassihi** and **Michael Levenson**.

ÉVIAN-LES-BAINS, France — President Trump on Wednesday issued a fiery defense of his deal with Iran, lashing out at critics who have said the agreement achieves even less than the one President Barack Obama negotiated, and threatening to bomb Iran again if it doesn’t adhere to the agreement.

Appearing at the Group of 7 summit of global leaders in Evian-les-Bains, France, Mr. Trump denied that the United States was, in effect, paying Iran to agree to the recently negotiated peace deal. And in an expletive-laden rant, he proclaimed that his deal was better than the one Mr. Obama signed with Tehran in 2015.

“And you know what the Iranians did? They laughed at Obama, and they said, ‘He’s a stupid son of a bitch,’” Mr. Trump said.

A spokeswoman for Mr. Obama said he would not be commenting on Wednesday, but referred to his remarks from an interview with ABC’s “Good Morning America” over the weekend. In it, he said that he doubted that the new deal would be “significantly different or a significant improvement” from the one his administration negotiated. He said that it was a reminder that the United States cannot just “bully our way or bomb our way to solutions.”

Mr. Trump’s remarks came as a senior U.S. official disclosed what the official said was the full text of the deal. The official read it aloud on a conference call with reporters on Wednesday, speaking on condition of anonymity under ground rules set by the White House.

The deal would, among other things, reopen the Strait of Hormuz, outline a \$300 billion plan for Iran’s reconstruction and at least temporarily lift restrictions on the country’s oil exports, according to the official. But it would push talks

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THE TEXT A look at the language of the agreement between the United States and Iran. PAGE A6

## Hunt for Clues in Crash of B-52, A Steady but Aging U.S. Staple

This article is by **Shawn Hubler, Dave Philipps** and **John Ismay**.

In the 10 years or so that Jeremy Smith worked as a flight test engineer at Edwards Air Force Base in Southern California, his wife said, he spoke over and over about the job’s risks.

“He loved his work — as a child, he knew he wanted to go into aeronautics,” Lauren Smith, 30, recalled in an interview on Tuesday about her 32-year-old husband. But as the father of two young children, he also understood the danger inherent to frequent test flights in military aircraft.

“All the time, he would talk about it,” she said.

On Monday, his worst fears came to pass with the crash of a B-52 bomber shortly after takeoff from the base. The aircraft burst into flames, and all eight crew members were killed in the conflagration, which was visible across the Mojave Desert for miles.

The cause of the crash, which occurred at 11:20 a.m. Monday, moments into a routine test mission, is under investigation. Air



The B-52 crash at Edwards Air Force Base left eight dead.

Force officials, who called it “unsurvivable,” said it could take up to six months to determine what happened.

B-52 bombers, which have been in use by the U.S. military since the 1950s, are known for their immense size, reliability and safety, but also for their advanced age. The test flight on Monday had been part of an Air Force initiative to upgrade the plane’s outdated radar and other avionics, which

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SPORTS B7-10

### Golf’s Geometric Challenge

Understanding the true brilliance behind Shinnecock Hills Golf Club’s design first requires a step back. PAGE B7

### Knicks’ Celebration Rolls On

A city already awash in orange and blue plans to continue the party through the Canyon of Heroes on Thursday. PAGE B10

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Gail Collins PAGE A18

